CASE STUDY

How a High-Volume Caterer Automated 100+ Weekly Proposals and Scaled to New Markets

urbn catering serves over 5,000 people daily through corporate catering, events, and meal programs across multiple locations. Here's how they 10x'd their operations without hiring.

urbn catering × Cynthia Concierge

THE CLIENT

A Multi-Concept Catering Powerhouse

urbn catering is a multi-concept catering company serving over 5,000 people daily through corporate catering, events, and meal programs across multiple locations. With rapid growth outpacing their team's capacity, the owner was working 70+ hours a week and facing a choice: hire 3–4 additional staff members, or find a better way.

THE PROBLEM

Scaling Faster Than Operations Could Handle

The business was expanding into new markets, but every part of the operation was bottlenecked by manual work:

- 100–150 weekly inquiries, each requiring a custom manual proposal

- Disorganized event tracking and team communication
- Invoicing bottlenecks with delayed Square payments
- Manual sales tax calculations for every location
- No client follow-up or repeat booking system
- Limited visibility into per-event profitability
- Expansion to LA and Silicon Valley seemed impossible without hiring

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THE SOLUTION

Cynthia as the Operations Backbone

Cynthia was implemented as a full-stack AI employee, handling seven core operational areas:

1

Lead Management & Proposals

Monitors inquiries, extracts event details, generates custom proposals with e-signature capability, and auto-follows up.

2

Scheduling & Coordination

Integrates with calendars, auto-schedules events, and sends job sheets directly to kitchen and service teams.

3

Invoicing & Payments

Generates Square invoices same-day, tracks outstanding receivables, and runs automated follow-ups at 7, 14, and 30 days.

4

Sales Tax Automation

Automatically looks up location-based tax rates for every event, eliminating manual calculations.

5

Client Communication

Sends confirmation texts, thank-you messages, review requests, and identifies

6

Profitability Analysis

Calculates margins per event, identifies cost drivers, and delivers weekly P&L

repeat booking opportunities.

reports by event type.

7

Market Expansion

Replicates all workflows for new locations — enabling dual-market launches with zero additional hires.

THE RESULTS

Measurable Impact Across Every Metric

METRIC	BEFORE	AFTER	CHANGE
Proposal response time	4–6 hours	12 minutes	**-95%**
Weekly proposals sent	40–50	120+	**+150%**
Invoice turnaround	3–5 days	Same day	**-90%**
30+ day overdue invoices	$47,000	$8,200	**-83%**
Monthly Google reviews	2–3	18	**+500%**
Owner admin hours / week	35	6	**-83%**
Repeat bookings	12%	31%	**+158%**

$73K
additional monthly revenue from faster proposals

$39K
recovered overdue invoices in 60 days

2
new markets launched without additional hires

OWNER TESTIMONIAL

> *"We were turning away business because we couldn't write proposals fast enough. Now Cynthia handles it all. She sends proposals at 2 AM. She even figured out we were losing money on events under 50 people. Last month we launched in LA. I didn't hire anyone."*
>
> — Owner, urbn catering

WHY IT WORKED

Not a Chatbot. A Full Operations Layer.

End-to-End Automation

Executes complete workflows from inquiry to invoice — not just canned responses.

Process-Trained

Adapted to urbn's exact templates, pricing tiers, and communication style.

Deep Tool Integration

Scales Without Hiring

Works natively within Square, Google Calendar, and email — no copy-paste handoffs.

Handled doubled holiday volume and dual market launches with zero new employees.

1,240%

ROI within 90 days

Cynthia cost less than one part-time employee, operates 24/7, and scales instantly. From proposals to invoicing to market expansion — one AI employee replaced an entire back-office team.

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